

Business As A Platform To Enable Innovation

While several emerging technologies such as AI, IoT, blockchain, and others enable significant economic changes, the time is ripe to make transformative changes. Hence the business as a platform!



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When engineering and electronics giant Siemens wanted to launch hearing aids for kids, they faced an interesting challenge. Leadership was contemplating, “How do you market hearing aids to kids?” Despite being a necessity, how do you make them attractive? How do you make them look cool and not weird?

Now for all their experience and technical expertise, these questions were far out of their comfort zone. Their history, their strategy, their culture had never encountered a challenge of marketing technology to kids.

The first question they asked was, “Which of our full-time employees can take this assignment?” Unfortunately, the answer turned out to be, “No one.”

Then the leadership team reframed the

question and asked, “Who gets kids to do this job better in the world?” This time, the answer was obvious, “Disney.”

Eventually, Siemens and Disney collaborated for a longer term. Siemens essentially borrowed Disney employees’ services for this work.

This is a classic example of how building your business as a platform can expand the gamut of your offerings and take your business to a whole new level.

Collaboration is the best choice when you’re faced with challenging work out of your comfort zone.

Building your business as a platform

Every time I strike a conversation talking about business as a platform, people often